

SOUL CLASH - FULL RULES REPORT

GAME OVERVIEW

- Single PC, pass-and-play. The PC screen is a shared "game progress dashboard" showing state (hearts, shields, marks visible where applicable, charges, etc).
- A human moderator runs the dashboard and privately handles any hidden information (e.g. Akyros's Hidden Mark) and randomizers (coin flips, RPS).

MODES

- 2-Player: each player picks 2 characters.
- 4-Player: each player picks 1 character.

TURN STRUCTURE

- A "round" = one player's full turn, taken in seat order

(P1 -> P2 [-> P3 -> P4]).

- On their turn, a player acts with ALL of their non-KO'd characters. For each character, the player freely chooses which available action to use (normal ability or special, subject to that character's own gating rules described below).
- Targeting is always fully manual: the active player chooses any enemy character for each ability use, unless a card's own rules restrict this (e.g. Blade's streak tracking, Akyros's marks, Athena's curse target).

LIFE / SHIELD SYSTEM

- Every character has 7 hearts (lives). Damage subtracts directly from hearts. 0 hearts = KO'd.
- Shields absorb incoming damage before hearts are touched, but shield behavior differs per character (see individual sections below) - some are permanent stacking pools, others decay after 1 round.
- A KO'd character is removed from play. A player is only eliminated once ALL of their characters are KO'd. Last player standing wins the match.
- Exception: Blade's Rebirth special (see below) can bring him back once.

1. CHRONOX - Time Controller

Chrono Guard (passive, always on)

- Chronox has 1 shield active from the very start of the match, before anyone has taken a turn.
- At the start of each of Chronox's own turns, his shield RESETS to exactly 1 - it does not stack or accumulate turn to turn.
- Within a single round (before the next reset), the shield is a depleting pool consumed hit-by-hit as damage lands. If Chronox is hit multiple times in the same round (e.g. by two different enemy characters in a 2v2), the 1 shield absorbs the first point of damage from the first hit and is then exhausted, so a second hit that round lands at full damage.

Cyclone Punch (normal action, every turn, any target)

- Flip a coin: Heads -> target loses 2 hearts. Tails -> target loses 1 heart. (Damage applies after shield absorption as normal.)

Time Freeze (special, 1x per match, targets one enemy)

- Initial use: the target skips their very next turn. No coin flip needed for this first skip.

- From Chronox's NEXT turn onward, EVERY subsequent turn of his triggers an automatic bonus coin flip - regardless of who he actually attacks that turn with Cyclone Punch (he is free to attack anyone, not just the frozen target):

Heads -> freeze continues, frozen target skips their next turn again.

Tails -> freeze ends permanently.

- Only the frozen character skips their own turn - not their whole player's turn (relevant when a player controls 2 characters).

2. THAROX - Titan Warrior

Four possible actions, player's free choice each turn (subject to gating):

Smash (normal, any target)

- Flat -1 heart. No conditions.

Titan Toss (normal, no damage/target)

- Grants Tharox a "Titan Smash charge." Only usable if Tharox does NOT already hold a charge.

Titan Smash (normal, follow-up, any target)

- Deals -3 hearts. Only usable while holding a charge (from Titan Toss OR from Glory Smash). Consumes the charge. This ends the combo.

Glory Smash (special, 1x per match, follow-up, any target)

- Deals -2 hearts to the target, plus Tharox gains +2 hearts (self-heal) and +2 shield for 1 round only (decays after, even if untouched - unlike Chronox's permanent stacking shield).

- Only usable while holding a charge. Consumes the current charge AND grants a brand-new Titan Smash charge in its place, allowing a further Titan Smash later.

MANDATORY CASH-IN: after Titan Toss (or after Glory Smash grants a new charge), Tharox's very next actionable turn MUST be Titan Smash or Glory Smash - he cannot use Smash instead, and cannot Toss again while holding a charge. The only thing that delays this obligation is being frozen (e.g. by Chronox's Time Freeze) and skipping a turn - the charge simply waits, and the mandatory-use requirement resumes on his next actionable turn once unfrozen. Taking damage from other players in between does not affect the charge or the obligation.

Max chain: Toss -> Glory Smash -> Titan Smash (3 turns, only possible once per match since Glory Smash is 1x). Shorter chain Toss -> Titan Smash can recur any number of times across the match.

3. ZERATHYS - Storm Mage

Two normal actions, player's free choice each turn:

Charge Up (normal, no damage/target)

- +1 to Zerathys's charge counter (max 2, caps there). Banked charge persists indefinitely across turns until spent on Thunder Wrath - it does not decay on its own and survives skipped turns.

Thunder Wrath (normal, any target)

- Deals damage based on CURRENT charge level, then resets the charge to 0 afterward:

0 Charge -> -1 heart

1 Charge -> -2 hearts

2 Charges -> -3 hearts

- To repeatedly hit for -3, Zerathys must re-charge twice between each use (Charge, Charge, Wrath, Charge, Charge, Wrath...). Attacking every turn without charging just chips -1 heart each time.

Soul Swap (special, 1x per match, targets any enemy)

- Swaps CURRENT hearts totals between Zerathys and the target. (Smart play: swap when the target has MORE hearts than Zerathys, stealing their higher pool and dumping his lower total onto them.)

- Immediately follows with a free Thunder Wrath (does not cost a separate turn) against ANY target (not necessarily the same one just swapped with), using whatever charge is currently banked - that charge resets to 0 afterward as normal.

4. AKYROS - Shadow Assassin

Hidden Mark (normal action, no damage)

- Secretly marks a target. Since this is a shared single-dashboard game, the player tells the moderator privately which enemy to mark; the dashboard does not reveal it.

- Multiple enemies can be marked at the same time. Marking a new target does NOT remove existing marks. Marks are PERMANENT - they never expire or auto-clear for the rest of the match.

- A mark is only revealed to other players once Fatal Slash is used against that marked target.

- The player may also re-mark an already-marked target. This has no extra mechanical effect - it's a legal "pass"/stalling move used purely for strategy (e.g. baiting opponents, avoiding revealing info yet).

Fatal Slash (normal action, every turn, any target)

- Marked target -> -2 hearts (this reveals that the target was marked).

- Unmarked target -> -1 heart.

Dodge (passive, always on)

- Per-attacker tracking: the very FIRST attack any given enemy character EVER lands on Akyros (across the whole match, not per-round) deals 0 damage. Once that enemy's first hit has been negated, all of their subsequent attacks on Akyros land normally for the rest of the match. Each enemy character has their own independently tracked "first hit."

Shadow Execution (special, 1x per match)

- Requires at least one active mark to exist somewhere among the enemies. Player chooses any currently marked enemy as the target: -3 hearts, ignoring shields entirely.

- Does NOT consume/remove the mark - it remains on that target afterward (since marks never expire).

5. VELORYA - Moon Assassin

Turn 1 of the match

- Velorya's very first attack must be Lunar Strike, OR she may instead open directly with Lunar Eclipse (special). Moonstep is not available yet since there is no prior target to compare against.

Lunar Strike (normal action, any target)

- Flat -1 heart, ignoring shields.

Moonstep (normal action, any target, available from her 2nd attack onward)

- Compares ONLY to her immediately preceding attack's target (not full history):

Different target than her last attack -> -2 hearts, ignoring shields.

Same target as her last attack -> -1 heart, ignoring shields (same as Lunar Strike).

- Ping-ponging between two targets each turn nets -2 hearts every time, since the target always differs from the immediately prior one.

Lunar Eclipse (special, 1x per match, no target/self-buff)

- Velorya becomes untargetable by enemy attacks. She still takes her normal turns (Lunar Strike/Moonstep) while this is active.

- After each of her attacks during this state, flip a coin:

Heads -> untargetable continues.

Tails -> untargetable ends permanently (single use, like all specials).

Interaction with Athena: Velorya's untargetable status does NOT block Athena's Curse Strike mirrored damage (see Athena section) - because that damage isn't a targeted attack selection against Velorya, it's a side-effect mirror of damage Athena herself takes.

6. BOINGO - Chaos Trickster

Chaos Gamble (normal action, every turn, any target)

- The moderator resolves a Rock-Paper-Scissors matchup between Boingo and the target off-dashboard (no separate dashboard input needed - moderator just applies the result):

Boingo wins -> target -3 hearts (Giant Explosive Punch)

Draw -> target -1 heart (Giant Punch)

Boingo loses -> 0 hearts, no effect (Miss)

Jester Ball (special, 1x per match, thrown at one target)

- Does NOT resolve immediately. The ball sits with the current holder until THAT PLAYER'S OWN next turn, where handling the ball becomes their action for that turn. The holder must choose one of:

Return to Boingo -> Boingo gains +4 hearts (self-heal).

Pass to a different player -> that player becomes the new holder, same deal applies on their own next turn - BUT only one pass total is allowed for the whole Jester Ball sequence.

Take it -> holder loses -4 hearts.

- Once the ball has been passed once, the second (final) holder no longer has the pass option - only Return (Boingo +4 hearts) or Take (-4 hearts to self) are available to them.

7. BLADE - Blood Hunter

Blood Hunt (normal action, every turn, any target)

- Tracks a consecutive-hit streak against whichever single target Blade has been attacking.

1st hit on a given target: -1 heart.

Each consecutive hit on the SAME target (2nd, 3rd, ...): damage increases by +1 heart per hit in the streak (-1, -2, -3, -4, -5, ...), with no cap.

- Switching to a DIFFERENT target fully resets the streak to -1 heart on the new target - no memory of the previous target's streak count is kept.
- If Blade is frozen/skips a turn (e.g. via Chronox's Time Freeze), the streak does NOT reset - it pauses and resumes from where it left off once he acts again against the same target.

Rebirth (special, 1x per match)

- Automatic (not player-chosen) the instant Blade would be KO'd, if the special hasn't been used yet. Revives him with 2 hearts. Does not cost a turn/action.
- One-time only - if he is KO'd again after Rebirth, he is out of the match for good.

8. ATHENA - Curse Guardian

Curse Strike (normal action, every turn, VISIBLE to all players - unlike Akyros's Hidden Mark)

- Choose one player to curse. Only ONE curse is active at a time - choosing a new target moves the curse there and removes it from whoever was previously cursed.
- Choosing the same already-cursed target again is a valid strategic pass/no-op move.
- Curse mechanic: while a curse is active, whenever ATHENA takes damage from any attack (from anyone), the CURSED player also takes that same amount of damage as a mirrored copy. Athena still takes her own damage normally too
- this is not a redirect away from her; both she and the cursed player take the hit.
- The mirrored damage to the cursed player still passes through THEIR OWN shield normally (can be reduced/absorbed) - it does NOT ignore shields (unlike Akyros's Shadow Execution, which does ignore shields).
- Confirmed interaction: this mirrored damage is NOT blocked by Velorya's Lunar Eclipse untargetable status, because it isn't a targeted attack selection against the cursed player - it's a side-effect mirror triggered by Athena being hit.

Divine Restore (special, 1x per match)

- Athena gains +3 hearts (self-heal) and +2 shield for 1 round only (decays after, same pattern as Tharox's Glory Smash shield).

Note: Athena has no other direct-damage normal ability. Curse Strike (the curse placement itself) is her full normal action each turn - she has no separate attack move.

END OF REPORT